COMPLETE GUIDE

Build Your AI Brain

How to Export, Visualize & Search Your Entire ChatGPT and Claude History

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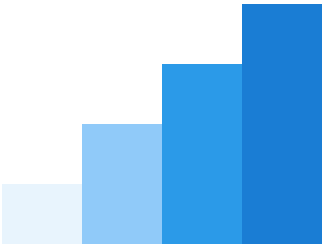

Table of Contents

01 Prerequisites

02 Export Your Data

03 Set Up Your Vault

04 Let Claude Code Do the Work

05 What You'll Get

06 Next Steps

SECTION 01

Prerequisites

> ⚠️ **IMPORTANT**
>
> If you don't have Claude Code, do not continue. You're going to need Claude Code to tag and link your chats — they won't automatically connect without it. I'll be posting Claude Code tutorials on my profile, so follow for that.

What You Need

- **Claude Code** (CLI) — the engine that organizes everything
- **Obsidian** (free) — the app that visualizes your vault
- **Your chat exports** from ChatGPT and/or Claude

This tutorial covers ChatGPT and Claude exports only. iMessages and Apple Notes will be covered in a following tutorial.

SECTION 02

Export Your Data

Claude (Fastest — ~5 minutes)

1. Go to **claude.ai**
2. Click your profile icon (bottom-left)
3. Go to **Settings**
4. Click **"Export Data"** under Privacy
5. You'll get an email within 5 minutes with a download link
6. Download and unzip — you'll get a `conversations.json` file

ChatGPT (Takes 1–3 days)

1. Go to **chatgpt.com**
2. Click your profile icon → **Settings**
3. Go to **Data Controls**
4. Click **"Export data"**
5. You'll get an email (can take up to a few days — be patient)
6. Download the ZIP from the email link and unzip it
7. You'll find multiple `conversations-XXX.json` files

> 💡 **PRO TIP**
>
> Claude sends your export in under 5 minutes. OpenAI can take days. Start your ChatGPT export first, then do Claude while you wait.

SECTION 03

Set Up Your Vault

1. Download **Obsidian** from **obsidian.md** (free)
2. Create a folder on your desktop called `Brain`
3. Put your Claude and ChatGPT export folders inside it
4. Open Obsidian → **"Open folder as vault"** → select `Brain`

SECTION 04

Let Claude Code Do the Work

1. Open your terminal
2. Navigate to your Brain folder:

BASH

```bash
cd ~/Desktop/Brain
```

3. Run `claude` to start Claude Code
4. Tell it:

PROMPT

```
Organize this folder into an Obsidian vault. Convert all my
ChatGPT and Claude conversations into individual markdown files
with proper frontmatter (title, date, tags, category). Then
launch 10 sub-agents to go through every conversation and
smartly tag things — names, people, places, recurring themes,
projects, and topics. Link everything together with wikilinks
so the Obsidian graph connects related conversations.
```

5. Let it run — Claude Code will create subagents that process everything in parallel
6. When it's done, go back to Obsidian and hit **Cmd+G** (Mac) or **Ctrl+G** (Windows) to see your graph

SECTION 05

What You'll Get

- Every conversation as a **searchable markdown file**
- **Tags and categories** on everything
- A **visual graph** showing how your ideas, projects, and conversations connect
- **Full-text search** across your entire AI history
- **Entity pages** for people, projects, and topics that link all related conversations

REAL-WORLD RESULTS

I ran this on 2,021 ChatGPT conversations and 363 Claude conversations spanning 3+ years. The result is a 5,000+ file vault with 14 AI-generated insight reports, entity pages for 80+ people and projects, and a graph that connects everything from my first GPT prompt ("How did Andrew Tate get rich?") to my latest Claude Code session.

SECTION 06

Next Steps

- **Follow @alex2learn** for the Claude Code setup tutorial
- **Coming soon:** Adding iMessages, Apple Notes, and voice memos to your vault
- **Pro tip:** Run a sync script periodically to keep your vault updated with new Claude Code sessions

PLATFORM	EXPORT TIME	FILE FORMAT	WHERE TO FIND IT
Claude	~5 minutes	conversations.json	Settings → Privacy → Export Data
ChatGPT	1–3 days	conversations-XXX.json	Settings → Data Controls → Export
iMessages	Coming soon	TBD	Follow @alex2learn for updates
Apple Notes	Coming soon	TBD	Follow @alex2learn for updates

YOUR BRAIN VAULT CHECKLIST

- [ ] Export Claude data (Settings → Privacy → Export Data)

- [ ] Export ChatGPT data (Settings → Data Controls → Export)
- [ ] Download and install Obsidian from obsidian.md
- [ ] Create Brain folder and add exports
- [ ] Open folder as Obsidian vault
- [ ] Run Claude Code to organize, tag, and link everything
- [ ] Explore your graph view (Cmd+G / Ctrl+G)
- [ ] Follow @alex2learn for the Claude Code tutorial and future updates

💡 **PRO TIP**

Bookmark alex2learn.com and follow @alex2learn on social media. The Claude Code setup tutorial, iMessage import guide, and Apple Notes integration are all coming soon.